

ChatGPT attacks the spine (v1.2), step 3 round two

Received 2026-08-30, verbatim except that em dashes are normalised to colons per the house rule. GPT returned the response twice, the first copy cut off mid-finding 8; the complete second copy is recorded. Attachments were the v1.2 spine pdf and the round-one findings pdf. Disposition per finding is in the status table; repairs are in spine v1.3.

Status

#	Finding	Status	Repair (v1.3)
1	Margo to Del on Day 44 makes Del preserve the loading-bay footage before it expires on Days 47 and 49; it shows Brad twice	Accepted, the real one	Margo's turn moves past the tape: the money is re-read at meeting 5 (Day 47), her file check is Day 51, the sums Days 51 to 53, silence at meeting 6 (Day 54), Brad goes Day 60. Her earliest route to Del now finds two expired tapes. Everything from the vanish to the landlord shifts seven days; the stranger, the second death and Ally are unchanged. The lock is nine days, still named
2	Liam's rows kept the pre-R22 response	Accepted	C3 weeks 3, 4 and 9 rewritten with examination first
3	C8 still said No. 14 was not asked	Accepted	C8 row corrected to the v1.2 door-knock
4	The platform woman's tip says "the Monday"	Accepted	"The Saturday the car was found", in A5 and B6 row 60
5	The Day 333 arrest row still names Brad's flat as the deckhand's last address	Accepted	Row corrected: the boat; the skipper's link (finding 8) is what snaps together at Del's desk
6	Board provenance plus the empty hook plus "something flat" gives the Day 222 detective a tampering hypothesis and reaches the fishmonger	Accepted, repaired at source	Brad leaves with the board in the rucksack he brought for the book. No. 14 sees a man's back and nothing in his hands. The hook photograph is consistent with Violet taking the board down on Day -19, which is what the survivors tell police. No hypothesis arises
7	Brad's Day 2 denial becomes material on Day 222 once 6 lands	Falls with 6	No object, no build match, no cage access: the denial stays an unidentified man in a lane
8	The skipper only knows "a mate's" and cannot link Brad	Accepted	The deckhand had said "Brad the signwriter, the one with the van". The skipper was never asked in -1090 because a low-risk report does not take drinking companions (R16). He writes on Day 311; Del revives the file, runs the name, finds nothing since -1090 (row 10d), and holds the link until Day 333
9	Activating the prepaid demands photo ID	Answered from the settled list	v8 settled "a cash number" and "a number that leads nowhere"; Havenbay prepaids are anonymous, or the premise had already failed at round one. Recorded in B1 as row 10e
10	The Saturday chain from the car to Tessa	Accepted, and it improves the world	Officers attend Margo's registered address on Saturday morning; in the kitchen drawer is an accountant's "in case" card naming Tessa. Tessa is on the file by 15:00 on Day 215. Nothing downstream depended on Sunday; the third thin lock closes

Also noted by GPT and carried: the forgery repair survives; row 5b survives at Day 19; the third thin lock (Saturday to Tessa) is closed by 10.

The response, verbatim

Verdict: REWORK

1. **Round-one 5, new B3 row 33 / C5: Day 44: Margo and Del. Confidence: 100%.** Margo lawfully holds her dated file note, Violet's direct account and the contradictory letter; when she takes them to Del, Del's first mandatory action is to preserve expiring evidence at the alleged placement site before the weeks-long R22 examination, so the Day 16 and Day 18 loading-bay footage is secured before Days 47 and 49 and shows Brad entering twice.

Wrong if: Havenbay permits an officer receiving a supported forgery allegation to postpone preservation of identified, expiring footage until document examination finishes.

1. **Round-one 3, new C3 weeks 3–8 and B4 row 40: Days 14, 19 and 55: Liam and Del. Confidence: 100%.** Liam lawfully holds the same letters as Ruby and may take them to Del, but his rows retain the superseded "read, note, ask the coroner" response; R22 makes Del's first mandatory action examination on every one of those dates.

Wrong if: R22 applies to Ruby's copy of a letter but not Liam's identical copy.

1. **Round-one 10, new C8: Day 1: No. 14 and the door-knocking officer. Confidence: 100%.** C8 still says No. 14 was not asked and the officer asked only when Violet was last seen, contradicting A2, B2 row 18 and C7, where No. 14 reports the man and flat object during the movements-and-visitors canvass.

Wrong if: C8 describes a different door-knock, which the document does not identify.

1. **Round-one 2, new A5 / B6 row 60: Day 318: the platform woman. Confidence: 100%.** Her tip still identifies "the Monday the car was found," but the repaired clock places Brad's van discovery on Saturday Day 54 and Margo's car discovery on Saturday Day 215, so the statement no longer identifies either journey accurately.

Wrong if: "Monday" refers to an event other than the car's discovery and that event is stated.

1. **Round-one 4, new A5: Day 333: the arresting officer. Confidence: 100%.** The arrest row still says the old missing-person file gives Brad Collins's flat as the deckhand's last address, directly contradicting repaired B1 row 10a and R26, which make the boat the last address and remove Brad entirely.

Wrong if: a second record independently connects the deckhand to Brad's flat before arrest; none is listed.

1. **New decoy, B3 row 31 / B7 R15–R16: Day 222: the assigned detective. Confidence: 98%.** The detective lawfully holds the name board, No. 14's statement and the Day 1 scene photographs; the first mandatory action is to establish the board's provenance, compare it with the pale rectangle and re-interview No. 14, producing a tampering hypothesis that activates R27 and leads to the fishmonger's memory of Brad's Day 16 visit.

Wrong if: the survivors never give police the load-bearing object or disclose that it normally hung on the photographed hook.

1. **B2 row 18 / C7: Days 54 and 222: Brad and Del. Confidence: 98%.** Brad's Day 2 denial costs little on Day 54 because nothing yet identifies No. 14's man, but after the board provenance and cage access emerge on Day 222, Del lawfully holds his denial, matching build, unit key and premature cage visit; her first mandatory action is to record Brad as the probable visitor and refer the combined evidence to the coroner's officer under R19.

Wrong if: No. 14's recorded build excludes Brad or the board cannot be matched to what the witness saw.

1. **Round-one 4 repair, B1 row 10c / A5: Day 311: the skipper. Confidence: 97%.** The skipper lawfully holds only "a mate's" and has never known the mate's name or address, so hearing Brad Collins named cannot make him know the deckhand drank at Brad's flat; he has nothing connecting Brad to take to Del.

Wrong if: the skipper previously saw Brad, heard his name or can identify his flat, in which case that fact belongs in the Day -1090 file and sweep.

1. **B1 rows 10 and 10d: Days -900 to -500: Brad and the prepaid provider. Confidence: 93%.** Brad's first ordinary identity-controlled interaction is activating the prepaid: he holds a dead man's passport with another face and a birth certificate without one, presents them to the provider, and the provider's first mandatory action is identity verification followed by refusal when the photograph does not match.

Wrong if: Havenbay permits anonymous prepaid activation, or accepts a birth certificate alone without face verification.

1. **A4 / B5 row 48: Day 215: the attending officer, office manager and Tessa. Confidence: 90%.** Registration gives police Margo's number and registered address, not her employer; after unanswered contact, the officer's first mandatory action is to attend the address and seek next of kin or emergency contacts, while any eventual call to the office requires the manager to check the personnel emergency contact, which may identify Tessa before Sunday.

Wrong if: the car is registered to the office and Margo has deliberately omitted Tessa from every employment, medical and emergency-contact record.

The forgery repair itself survives: the debt book supplies extensive personal cursive, the established years of private practice supply capability, and one final use of Violet's paper and pen leaves nothing the sister can distinguish on Day 82.

Row 5b also survives at Day 19 as written: no independent person is presently shown inside the house after Day -19. Its weakness appears later, when the Day 1 photograph, No. 14's flat object and the recovered board are combined.

The third thin lock is now the Saturday contact chain to Tessa. Margo's original six-day lock is worse than thin if she chooses Del on Day 44, because that route now preserves the camera and identifies Brad's early cage access.